

Nicholas Dunagan

Curriculum Vitae

Email: nick@dunagan.org

Website: nick.dunagan.org

Phone: (512) 633-1288

Research Interests

Industrial Organization, Game Theory, Innovation, Intellectual Property & Technology

Education

Ph.D. in Economics

Aug. 2022 to Present

Clemson University

Clemson, SC

Fields: Industrial Organization, International Trade

Advisors: Charles Thomas, F. Andrew Hanssen

B.B.A. in Economics

Aug. 2018 to December 2021

Texas State University

San Marcos, TX

Teaching Experience

Instructor

Fall 2024 to Present

Clemson University

Clemson, SC

- International Economy (Fall 2024, Spring 2025, Summer 2025, Fall 2025, Spring 2026, Summer 2026, Fall 2026)

Teaching Assistant

Fall 2022 to Summer 2024

Clemson University

Clemson, SC

- Principles of Microeconomics (Fall 2022, Spring 2023, Fall 2023)
- Principles of Macroeconomics (Fall 2022, Spring 2023, Spring 2024)
- International Economy (Summer 2024)

Current Research

Job Market Paper

Dunagan, N. "Strategic Search in Patenting"

I develop a three-player game-theoretic model of patenting. An *applicant* chooses how extensively to search for prior art, determining the information brought into the patenting process and the claimed patent breadth. An *examiner* conducts additional search and might narrow the claimed breadth. A *challenger* conducts additional search and might challenge the patent. The public record from earlier search affects the likelihood of challenge by affecting the informativeness of later search. My equilibrium characterization yields comparative statics for how search and breadth respond to challenger filing costs, procedural standards, and examiner capacity. These results generate testable implications for patent breadth, grant outcomes, and post-grant challenge behavior.

Working Papers

Dunagan, N. "Strategic Search in Patenting: An Empirical Investigation"

Using a newly constructed dataset linking U.S. patent applications and grants through 2020 and an exposure-based difference-in-differences design, I find that greater exposure to post-grant review leads applicants and examiners to pursue narrower patent claims.

Eaton, M., Dunagan N., & Stalvey B. "The Effects of Focused Deterrence on Crime and Community Outcomes in Philadelphia"

Works in Progress

Eaton, M. & Dunagan, N. "Judicial Bias in Capital Sentencing in Early 20th Century South Carolina"

Baier, S., Dunagan N., & Reesman, W. "Trade Shocks, Migration, and House Prices: The Role of Housing-Supply Elasticity"

Dunagan, N. "Radical Innovation and Innovation Strategy"

Research Presentations

2026

Southern Economic Association 96th Annual Meeting, Houston, TX
Clemson Industrial Organization Economics Workshop, Clemson, SC

2025

Southern Economic Association 95th Annual Meeting, Tampa, FL
Clemson Industrial Organization Economics Workshop (Fall), Clemson, SC
Clemson Industrial Organization Economics Workshop (Spring), Clemson, SC

2024

Clemson Industrial Organization Economics Workshop, Clemson, SC

Awards & Honors

Dr. Myles Wallace Annual Fellowship in Economics <i>Clemson University - John E. Walker Department of Economics</i>	2026 to Present
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Dr. Michael T. Maloney Annual Fellowship in Economics <i>Clemson University - John E. Walker Department of Economics</i>	2025 - 2026
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Graduate Assistant Excellence Award in Teaching <i>Clemson University - Powers College of Business</i>	2025
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Economics Department Travel Grant <i>Clemson University - John E. Walker Department of Economics</i>	2025
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Clemson University Graduate Student Government Travel Grant <i>Clemson University - Graduate Student Government</i>	2024 - 2026
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Clemson University Department of Economics Graduate Assistantship <i>Clemson University - John E. Walker Department of Economics</i>	2022 to Present
Texas State University Outstanding Undergraduate Student in Economics <i>Texas State University - McCoy College of Business</i>	2022
Larry and Robin Kapavik Scholarship <i>Texas State University</i>	2020-2021
Phi Kappa Phi Honor Society <i>Texas State University</i>	Fall 2020
Beta Gamma Sigma Honor Society <i>Texas State University</i>	Fall 2019

Specialized Skills

Technical: Python, STATA, R, C++, L^AT_EX, Git, Claude/ChatGPT Agents, Bloomberg Terminal, Microsoft Office Suite

References

Charles Thomas
Clinical Professor of Economics
Clemson University
cjt@clemson.edu

Scott L. Baier
Associate Dean of Research, Professor of
Economics
Clemson University
(864) 656-4534
sbaier@clemson.edu

F. Andrew Hanssen
Professor of Economics
Clemson University
fhansse@clemson.edu

Matthew S. Lewis
Professor of Economics
Clemson University
mslewis@clemson.edu